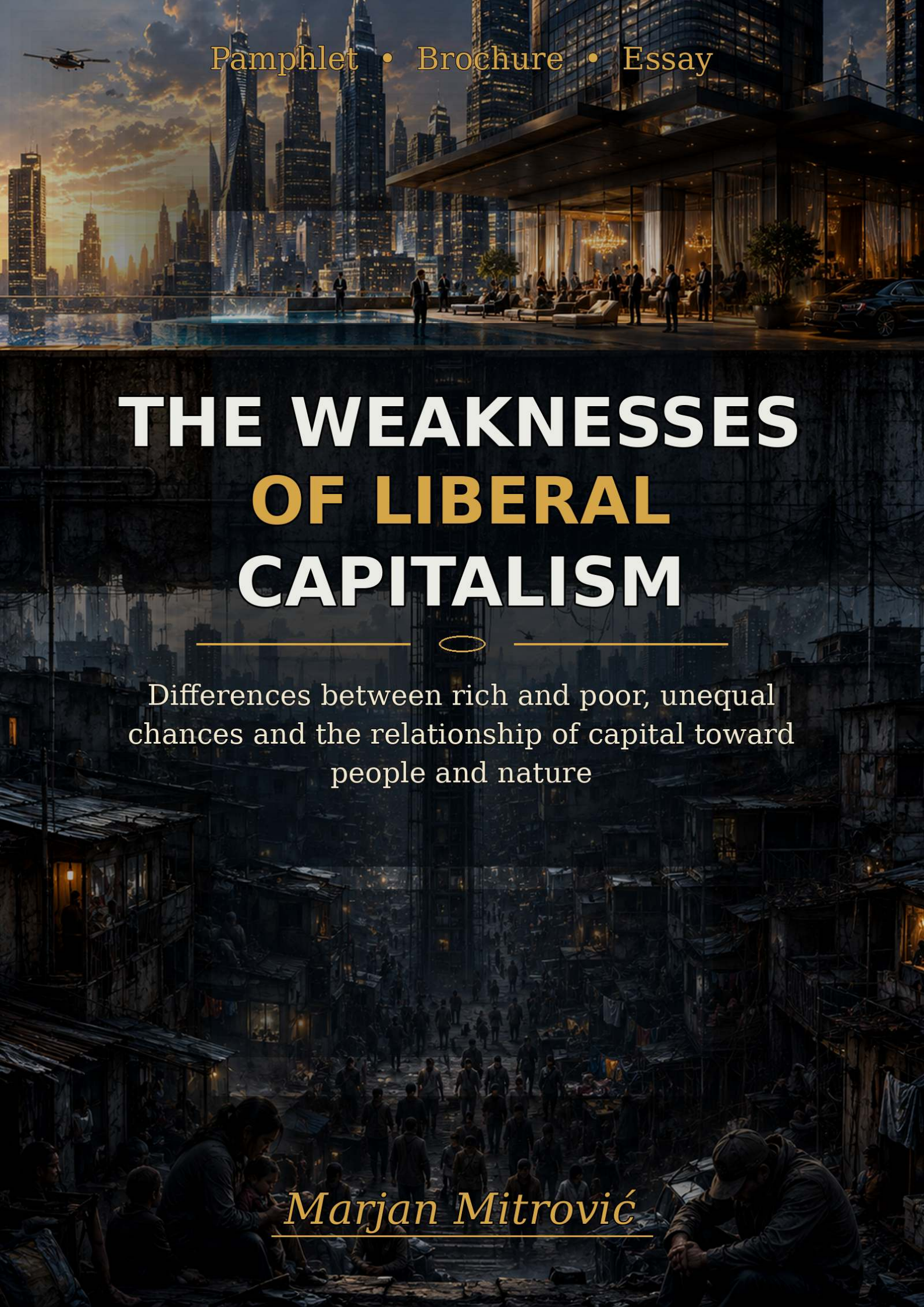




Pamphlet • Brochure • Essay

THE WEAKNESSES OF LIBERAL CAPITALISM

Differences between rich and poor, unequal
chances and the relationship of capital toward
people and nature

Marjan Mitrović

THE WEAKNESSES OF LIBERAL CAPITALISM

Pamphlet - brochure - essay

Differences between rich and poor, unequal chances and the relationship of capital toward people and nature

Author: Marjan Mitrović

Contents

1. Introduction
2. Differences Between Rich and Poor
3. Capital and the Human Being
4. Capital, Democracy and Power
5. Capital and Nature
6. Solution: An Economy in the Service of People and Nature
7. Education Available to Everyone
8. Internet for Learning and Education
9. Free Basic Energy from Renewable Sources
10. Technology and Work
11. Conclusion
12. Visual Appendix

Introduction

Liberal capitalism is often presented as a system of freedom, competition and equal opportunity. Its basic idea is that an individual, through work, talent and personal initiative, can advance and achieve a better life. However, reality shows that this system does not begin from equal foundations for everyone. Behind the promise of freedom there are often deep social differences, unequal chances, a concentration of wealth, and a relationship toward people and nature that is subordinated to profit.

The problem is not only that differences exist between people. The problem arises when those differences become permanent social walls: some inherit security, knowledge, connections and capital, while others inherit debt, insecurity and a struggle for basic needs. In that situation freedom exists formally, but not equally in real life.

Differences Between Rich and Poor

One of the greatest weaknesses of liberal capitalism is the enormous gap between rich and poor. In this system, wealth is not acquired only through work, but also through inheritance, ownership, access to capital, education, social connections and political influence. Children of the wealthy begin life with advantages: better schools, safer surroundings, private tutoring, family support, useful contacts and the ability to take risks without fear of complete collapse.

On the other hand, children of the poor often grow up in conditions where the struggle is for basic things: housing, food, health, education and security. Therefore the claim that everyone has equal chances remains largely theoretical. Formally, everyone can study, work, start a business or advance. But in practice, it is not the same to start from a secure family with money and to start from poverty, debt and insecurity.

Liberal capitalism often presents the success of the rich as proof of ability, and the failure of the poor as personal fault, even though the starting position was deeply unequal. Exceptions are presented as the rule, while systemic inequality is hidden behind motivational messages about effort, flexibility and personal responsibility.

Capital and the Human Being

A particular problem is the relationship of capital toward the human being. In a capitalist economy, a person is often viewed primarily as labor power, a cost, or a consumer. Human value is measured by productivity, by the profit one brings, and by one's ability to participate in the market. The worker becomes a number, wages become a cost, and human time is turned into a commodity.

Instead of the economy serving the human being, the human being is increasingly forced to adapt life to the demands of the market, the employer and profit. The consequences are insecurity, stress, exhaustion, alienation and the feeling that a person exists only to work, pay bills and consume.

Society depends on workers in factories, shops, transport, health care, schools, security, cleaning, agriculture and many other fields. Yet these jobs are often poorly paid, physically demanding and socially less respected. The paradox is that many of the most necessary jobs are the least valued, while financial speculation, ownership and the management of capital bring the greatest rewards.

Capital, Democracy and Power

Liberal capitalism also creates a great concentration of power. Large corporations and the wealthiest layers of society have enormous influence over politics, media, laws and public opinion. Although democratic institutions formally exist, economic power often means political power as well.

Those who have money can finance campaigns, lobby, control information and shape social priorities. In this way, freedom stops being equal for everyone. The rich do not only have more money; they also have more ways to protect and expand their own interests. Democracy without the economic power of ordinary people remains incomplete.

Capital and Nature

Another serious weakness of this system is its relationship to nature. Liberal capitalism is based on constant growth, production, consumption and competition. In such a system, nature is often not treated as the living framework of human existence, but as a source of raw materials, energy and profit.

Forests, rivers, land, animals and the climate gain value only when they can be used, sold or turned into economic gain. The consequences are pollution, destruction of ecosystems, climate change and depletion of resources. The system rewards short-term profit, while long-term consequences are often shifted onto society, poorer groups and future generations.

A company can make profit by polluting, but citizens pay the price of that pollution through illness, destroyed nature and a lower quality of life. The same applies to workers: profit is privatized, while the consequences of exhaustion, insecurity and poverty remain with individuals and society.

Solution: An Economy in the Service of People and Nature

The solution to the problems of liberal capitalism does not have to mean simply abolishing freedom, markets, private initiative or personal work. The problem is not that people want to create, work, advance and live better. The problem arises when profit becomes the highest principle of society, above people, nature, justice and dignity.

The first step is to return the human being to the center of society. A worker must not be seen only as a cost, a number or a means of creating profit. Every person must have the right to a dignified wage, safe working conditions, rest, health care, education and time for family and personal development.

The second step is to reduce inequality. This does not mean that everyone must have exactly the same, but that no one should be condemned to poverty because of place of birth, family, class or lack of initial opportunities. Education, health care, housing and basic security must be available to everyone, not only to those who can pay.

Education Available to Everyone

Education must have a special place. Knowledge must not be a privilege of the rich, but a common good. Every child, regardless of background, wealth or place of birth, must have access to quality education, modern schools, books, digital tools and the possibility to develop his or her talents.

In such a system, education would not be only preparation for the labor market. It would have to develop the whole human being: reason, morality, creativity, critical thinking, solidarity, science, art and a relationship with nature. Schools should not produce only obedient workers, but free people capable of understanding the world and changing it.

Internet for Learning and Education

Along with education, it is necessary to provide internet access intended for learning, information and education. In the modern world, access to the internet is no longer a luxury, but a condition for education, work, research and social participation.

Basic educational internet access must be available to everyone, especially children, students, workers who are retraining, and people who want to learn. Such internet should not serve manipulation, addiction and endless content consumption, but the development of knowledge, culture, science and critical thinking.

Free Basic Energy from Renewable Sources

Energy must also be understood as a basic social good. The basic amount of energy needed for a dignified life should be free or publicly guaranteed, especially if it comes from renewable sources such as sun, wind, water and geothermal energy.

The goal is not waste, but fair access to energy: that no one lives in cold, darkness or energy poverty, while at the same time dependence on fossil fuels is reduced and nature is protected. Free does not mean unlimited and irresponsible. Basic needs must be guaranteed, while excessive consumption, luxury waste and ecologically harmful activities must be more strictly regulated.

Technology and Work

In such a society, technology would have a completely different role from the one it often has today. Instead of serving primarily surveillance, manipulation, advertising, profit and the creation of dependence on consumption, technology would have to serve human liberation.

Automation, artificial intelligence, robotics and digital systems should reduce hard, dangerous and meaningless work, not create new insecurity and fear of losing one's job. If machines can produce more with less human labor, the benefit of that must not belong only to the owners of capital. Technological progress must mean shorter working time, more free time, more accessible education and greater security for everyone.

Conclusion

Liberal capitalism is a system that has brought technological development, production and certain forms of personal freedom, but at the same time it has created deep inequalities, insecurity and ecological crisis. Its greatest problem is not only that rich and poor exist, but that the wealth of some often rests on the insecurity of others and on the exhaustion of nature.

A fairer society must measure success differently: not by the wealth of the most powerful, but by the dignity of the ordinary person; not by the growth of profit, but by quality of life; not by the quantity of consumption, but by the health of people, nature and community. True progress exists only when a person has security, free time, education, health, a home, access to energy and the ability to develop his or her abilities without humiliation and fear.

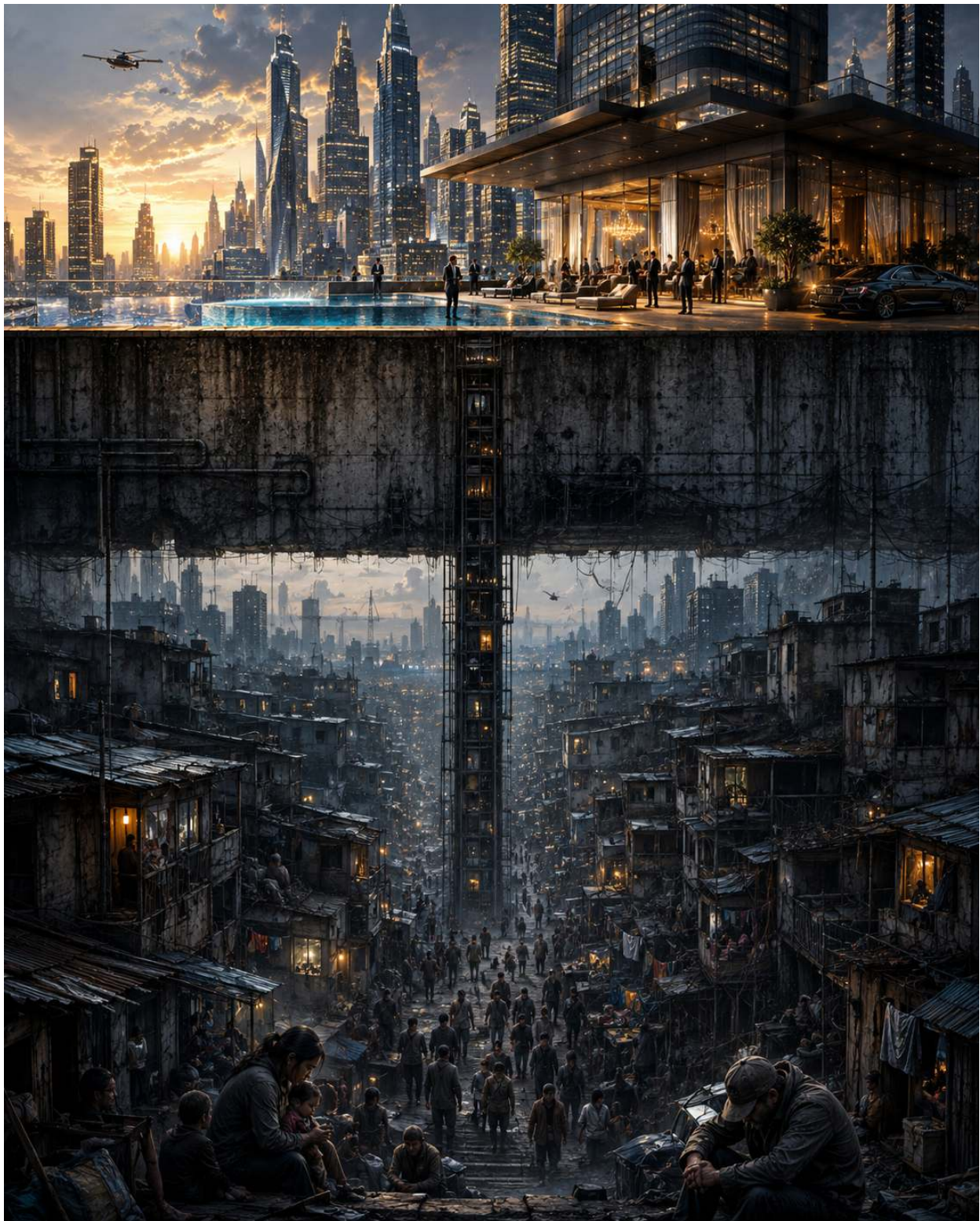
If we want a future that is more humane, more stable and more sustainable, we must abandon the logic in which everything is sold and everything is measured by price. We need a society in which basic needs are not treated as luxuries, but as rights; in which the worker is not a cost, but a human being; in which nature is not a commodity, but a condition of life; and in which wealth does not serve the accumulation of power, but the common good.

The future does not have to belong to capital. It can belong to the human being, the community and the planet.

Visual Appendix

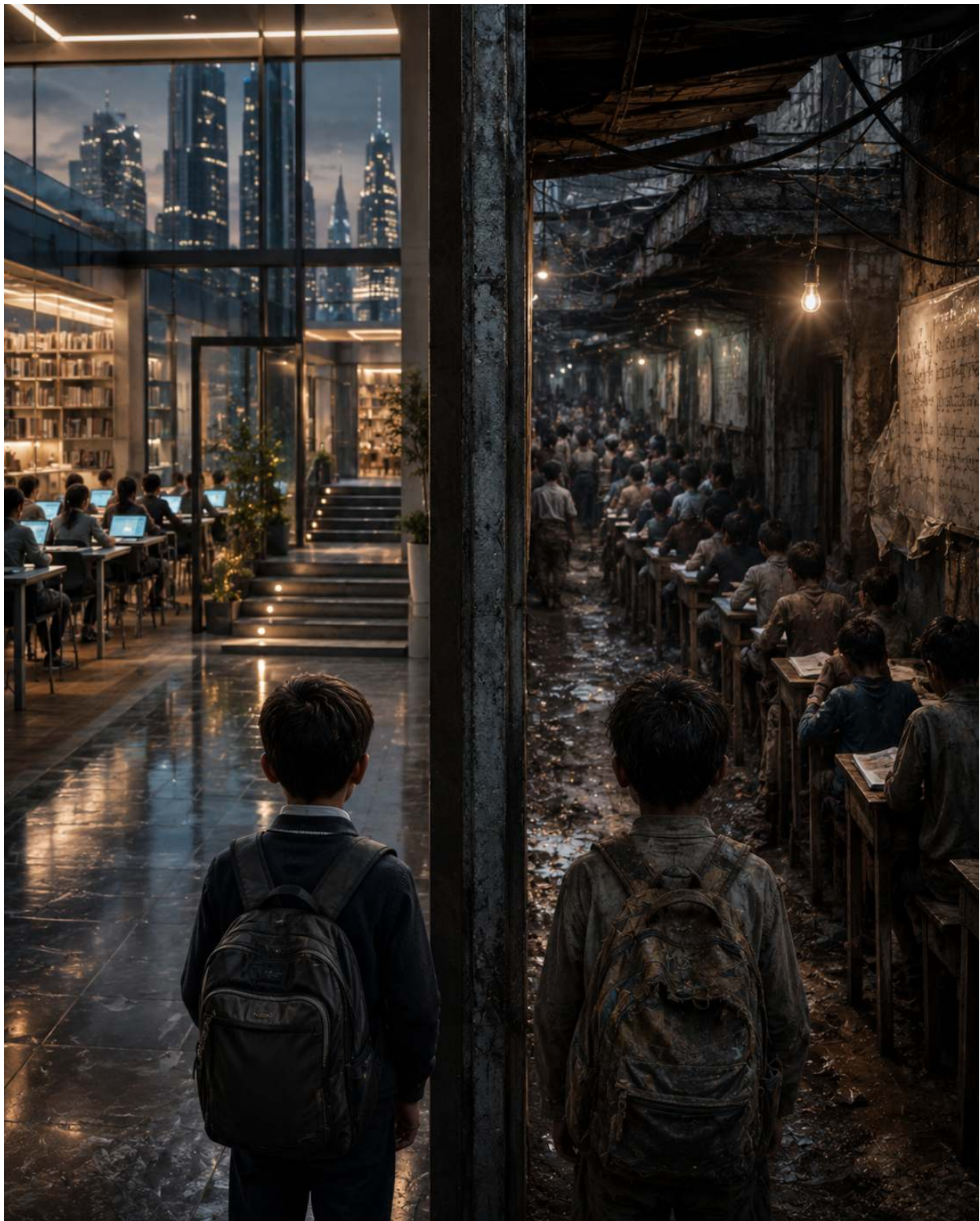
A series of visuals for the brochure, posts and promotion of the idea: from the critique of inequality to a humane, educated and ecological alternative.

Visual 01: Inequality Between Rich and Poor



Inequality Between Rich and Poor

Visual 02: Unequal Chances and Education



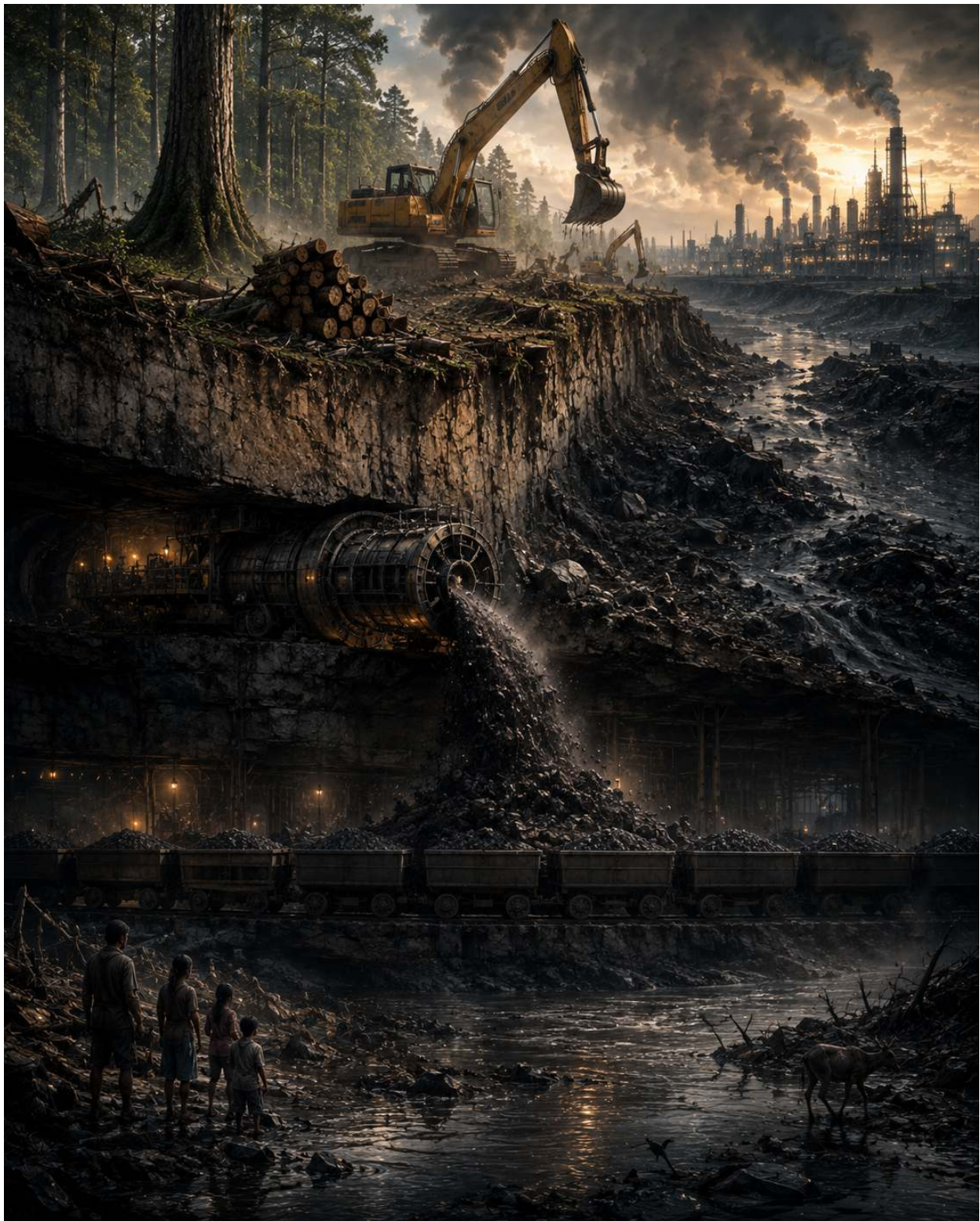
Unequal Chances and Education

Visual 03: The Human Being as Part of the Profit Machine



The Human Being as Part of the Profit Machine

Visual 04: Nature as a Raw Material for Capital



Nature as a Raw Material for Capital

Visual 05: Solution: Knowledge, Energy and Community



Solution: Knowledge, Energy and Community

Visual 06: Conclusion: Capital in the Service of Life



Conclusion: Capital in the Service of Life

Final Thought

Capital must be a tool, not a master. The economy must serve life, knowledge, nature and human dignity.

Marjan Mitrović